

The Computer Industry

Computing and Mathematics

May, 2026

The Computer Industry (A04921)

Short Title:	The Computer Industry	
Faculty	Science and Computing	
Department	Computing and Mathematics	
Cluster	Professional Skills	
Author	BLYNG	
Credits	5	Level: Introductory

Description of Module / Aims

The aim of this module is to introduce the student to the nature, structure, operating environment and markets of the major branches of the computer industry.

Programmes

COMP-0375	BSc (Hons) in Applied Computing (International) (WD_KACMI_B)	1 / 1 / M
COMP-0375	BSc (Hons) in Applied Computing (WD_KACCM_B)	1 / 1 / M
COMP-0375	BSc (Hons) in Applied Computing (WD_KCOMP_B)	1 / 1 / M
COMP-0375	BSc (Hons) in Computer Forensics and Security (WD_KCOFO_B)	1 / 1 / M
COMP-0375	BSc (Hons) in Computer Science (WD_KCMSC_B)	1 / 1 / M
COMP-0375	BSc (Hons) in the Internet of Things (International) (WD_KINTT_BI)	1 / 1 / M

Indicative Content

- Introduction and Overview
- Structure and organisation of the computing industry
- Marketing of high-technology products
- Market dynamics of the Computer Industry
- Intellectual Property Rights

Learning Outcomes

On successful completion of this module, a student will be able to:

1. Describe the organisational structure of key computer industry sectors.
2. Examine the macro and micro-environmental factors that impact the computer industry.
3. Examine the marketing strategies adopted by a company in the computer industry.
4. Distinguish between the various forms of intellectual property rights.
5. Express ideas and information clearly in visual, oral and written forms through in-class activities.

Learning and Teaching Methods

- Interactive and open-forum lectures will be used to introduce new concepts and to consider the concepts' implications for module deliverables.
- Self-directed learning activities will require students to will reflect upon the module materials, diagnose their learning needs and conduct research to satisfy these needs.

Assessment Methods

	Weighing	Outcomes Assessed
Continuous Assessment	100%	
Group Project	40%	1,2,5
Group Project	60%	3,4,5

Assessment Criteria

<40%: Unable to interpret and describe key concepts of the computing industry.

40%-49%: Be able to interpret and describe key concepts of the specific knowledge domain(s).

50%-59%: All the above and in addition demonstrate the ability to discuss key concepts of the computing industry and ability to discover and integrate related knowledge in other knowledge domains.

60%-69%: In addition, be able to solve problems within the computing industry by experimenting with the appropriate skills and tools.

70%-100%: 1: All the above to an excellent level. Be able to analyse and design solutions to a high standard for a range of both complex and unforeseen problems through the use and modification of appropriate skills and tools.

Learning Modes

Learning Mode	F/T Hours	P/T Hours
Lecture	36	
Independent Learning	99	

Supplementary Material

- "The Guardian Technology." <http://www.guardian.co.uk/technology>
- Arthur, C. _Digital Wars: Apple, Google, Microsoft and the Battle for the Internet_. London: Kogan Page, 2012.
- Brynjolfsson, E. and A. McAfee. _The Second Machine Age - Work, Progress, and Prosperity in a Time of Brilliant Technologies_. New York: W. W. Norton & Company, 2016.
- Yoffie, D. and M. Cusumano. _Strategy Rules: Five Timeless Lessons from Bill Gates, Andy Grove, and Steve Jobs_. New York: HarperBusiness, 2015.